

The climate crisis is also a mental health threat

As the global climate crisis **deepens**, its **devastating** impacts on human health and well-being have been thrown into **stark** relief. According to the World Bank, by 2050, **the number** of deaths caused by the climate crisis **could** reach between 14.5-15.6 million.

The focus remains on visible impacts like asthma, allergies and heat stress. **Mental health**, **often** neglected, however **is** also affected. The IPCC's Sixth Assessment **highlights** the climate crisis's **adverse** effects on global physical and regional mental health.

The psychological **cost** of the climate crisis **has** been "hidden", to a certain extent, **erasing** it from both policy and planning. When we examine the **outsized** threat we are facing, it is important to keep in mind that close to a billion people are living with mental health **disorders**. This is **unquestionably** a public health crisis, and we need better ways to measure and identify the wide-ranging impact of the climate crisis on mental health. **Extreme heat** also **disproportionately affects** the poorest citizens more likely to be working outdoors or in poorly-ventilated spaces -- leading to stress **on account of** being forced to choose between heat **exposure** and income loss.

Research increasingly indicates that psychiatric patients could be more **vulnerable** to heat impacts. Additionally, a 2021 study revealed that higher temperatures, especially at night, lead to poor quality sleep. And another recent report, on future impacts of climate change, says post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) after extreme weather events such as flooding is **projected** to become one of the worst health impact of the climate crisis by 2050

We need to tackle the **perception** of climate change as **divorced** from emotional and psychological reactions. The American Psychology Association (APA) describes eco-anxiety as "the **chronic** fear of environmental **cataclysm** that comes from observing the seemingly **irrevocable** impact of climate change and the **associated** concern for one's future and that of next generations". In a 2021 Lancet survey of 10,000 people aged 16-25 in 10 countries, nearly 60% of **respondents** were highly worried about the climate crisis, and more than 45% said their feelings about the climate crisis affected their daily lives, such as their ability to work or sleep.

Though the climate crisis affects us all, the **burden** of the climate **breakdown is** disproportionately **borne** by our most underserved, **marginalised** communities, which worsens already widespread inequality. It has become increasingly clear that climate change intensifies mental health issues experienced by people, such as PTSD, depression, anxiety and substance abuse, especially as extreme weather events increase in frequency and **tenor**. The ongoing crisis **exacerbates** social inequality across the world as they disproportionately impact vulnerable people, **fragile** health systems, and poor countries. Those at **heightened** risk are people with prior experiences of **deprivation**, mental health issues, women (particularly pregnant or **postnatal**) and children. The mental health impacts of the climate crisis are, and will continue to be, unequally distributed globally, and those **anticipated** to **bear the brunt** of these impacts include people living in ecologically-sensitive areas, resource-

dependent populations (farmers, fisherfolk, **Indigenous** peoples), people with pre-existing health conditions and stressors and people with limited resources and ability to respond.

We can still turn this situation around. **Policies** to reduce GHG emissions and **adapt to** climate change **can** improve living conditions and have both direct and indirect benefits on mental health. For example, better public transportation systems ensure better access to job opportunities and **amenities**, reducing stress and inequalities. **Neighbourhoods** with green spaces experience smaller heat impacts, and also **have** access to space for active **mobility** and socialising -- both of which contribute to better mental health. Improved building efficiency reduces the costs of energy bills, and reduces stress on poorer communities and protects them from the **vagaries** of energy costs. The Parques del Rio Norte **project** in northern Medellín, Columbia, **is** a prime example as it protects low-income communities from flooding, boosts green space per capita, and reduces **greenhouse emissions**, promoting mental health and wellbeing.

Ending with a story of hope, the **thinning** of the ozone layer **was** the climate crisis problem of its day, but collective action succeeded in reducing the emissions of **ozone-depleting** gases by more than 99%. The **fight** against the climate crisis **is** a fight for **optimism** and while anger and a sense of defeat seem valid and must be **acknowledged**, we must leave **room** for meaningful action for our collective future.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Deepen** (verb) – intensify, worsen, escalate, heighten, amplify बढ़ना / गहराना
2. **Devastating** (adjective) – destructive, ruinous, catastrophic, calamitous, damaging विनाशकारी
3. **Stark** (adjective) – clear, harsh, evident, sharp, severe तीव्र / कठोर
4. **Often** (adverb) – frequently, regularly, repeatedly, commonly, usually अक्सर
5. **Highlight** (verb) – emphasize, underline, stress, bring attention to, spotlight जोर देना
6. **Adverse** (adjective) – harmful, negative, unfavorable, detrimental, damaging प्रतिकूल
7. **Erase** (verb) – remove, eliminate, delete, obliterate, wipe out मिटाना
8. **Outsized** (adjective) – enormous, excessive, extreme, huge, overwhelming अत्यधिक
9. **Disorder** (noun) – illness, condition, imbalance, dysfunction, disease विकार
10. **Unquestionably** (adverb) – undeniably, definitely, absolutely, surely, certainly निस्संदेह
11. **Disproportionately** (adverb) – excessively, unfairly, unequally, imbalancedly, unevenly असमान रूप से
12. **On account of** (phrase) – because of, due to, owing to, as a result of, for the reason of के कारण
13. **Exposure** (noun) – contact, vulnerability, openness, experience, subjection संपर्क / अनावरण
14. **Vulnerable** (adjective) – susceptible, weak, unprotected, exposed, defenseless असुरक्षित
15. **Project** (verb) – forecast, predict, estimate, foresee, anticipate पूर्वानुमान लगाना
16. **Perception** (noun) – view, understanding, interpretation, opinion, belief धारणा
17. **Divorce** (verb) – separate, disconnect, isolate, detach, disassociate अलग करना
18. **Chronic** (adjective) – long-term, persistent, continuing, constant, habitual दीर्घकालिक / पुराना
19. **Cataclysm** (noun) – disaster, catastrophe, upheaval, calamity, crisis महाविपत्ति
20. **Irrevocable** (adjective) – irreversible, unchangeable, final, permanent, binding अपरिवर्तनीय
21. **Associated** (adjective) – related, connected, linked, tied, correlated संबंधित

22. **Respondent** (noun) – participant, interviewee, answerer, subject, survey taker उत्तरदाता
23. **Breakdown** (noun) – collapse, failure, deterioration, disruption, disintegration विघटन / पतन
24. **Bear** (verb) – carry, endure, shoulder, withstand, suffer सहना / उठाना
25. **Marginalised** (adjective) – excluded, neglected, sidelined, disadvantaged, oppressed उपेक्षित
26. **Tenor** (noun) – tone, character, mood, nature, essence स्वर / प्रवृत्ति
27. **Exacerbate** (verb) – worsen, intensify, aggravate, heighten, inflame और खराब करना
28. **Fragile** (adjective) – weak, delicate, brittle, sensitive, breakable नाजुक
29. **Heightened** (adjective) – increased, intensified, elevated, amplified, escalated बढ़ा हुआ
30. **Deprivation** (noun) – lack, absence, scarcity, hardship, poverty अभाव
31. **Postnatal** (adjective) – after childbirth, postpartum, following delivery, neonatal प्रसवोत्तर
32. **Anticipate** (verb) – expect, foresee, predict, prepare for, envision पूर्वानुमान लगाना
33. **Bear the brunt** (phrase) – suffer most, face the worst, take the impact, endure the main force सबसे अधिक झेलना
34. **Indigenous** (adjective) – native, local, aboriginal, original, ethnic स्वदेशी / आदिवासी
35. **Adapt** (to) (verb) – adjust, modify, change, conform, accommodate अनुकूल होना
36. **Amenity** (noun) – facility, convenience, comfort, utility, service सुविधा
37. **Mobility** (noun) – movement, motion, transport, travel, flexibility गतिशीलता
38. **Vagary** (noun) – unpredictability, fluctuation, whim, inconsistency, change अस्थिरता
39. **Greenhouse emission** (noun) – Greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions from human activities intensify the greenhouse effect ; Carbon dioxide is the main greenhouse gas resulting from human activities. ग्रीनहाउस उत्सर्जन
40. **Thinning** (noun) – reduction, weakening, depletion, lessening, decline क्षरण
41. **Ozone-depleting** (adjective) – ozone-damaging, ozone-reducing, atmosphere-

harming, layer-affecting, pollutant ओजोन
क्षरण करने वाला

42. **Optimism** (noun) – hopefulness, positivity,
confidence, faith, encouragement आशावाद

43. **Acknowledge** (verb) – accept, recognize,
admit, appreciate, concede स्वीकार करना /
मान्यता देना

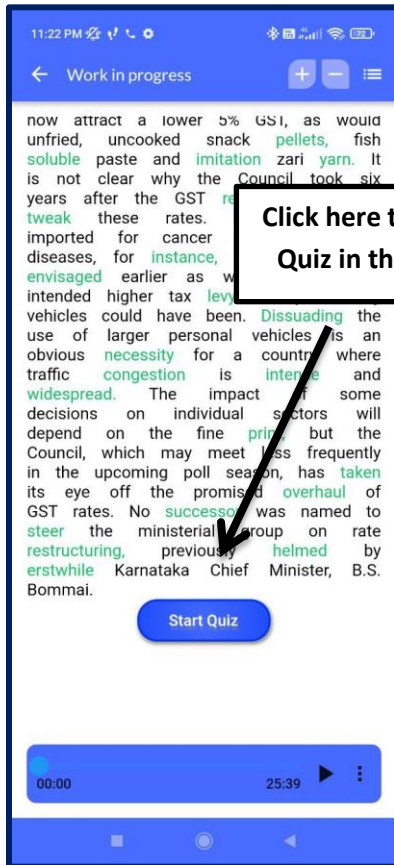
44. **Room** (noun) – space, opportunity,
capacity, scope, allowance गुंजाइश

@mocks_wallah

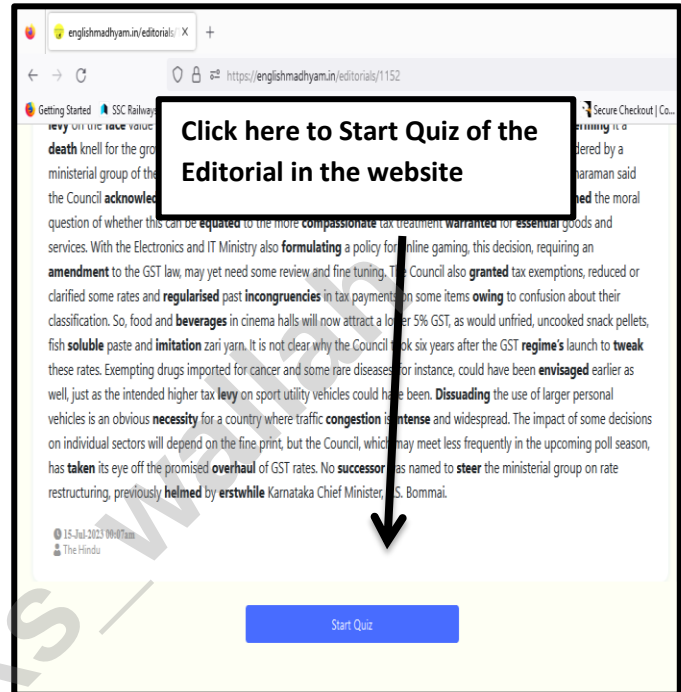
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Rising Death Toll** – The World Bank warns that by 2050, climate-related deaths could reach 14.5–15.6 million globally.
2. **Neglected Mental Health** – While physical health effects like asthma and heat stress are acknowledged, the mental health impacts remain largely ignored.
3. **IPCC Warning** – The IPCC's Sixth Assessment Report emphasizes both physical and **regional mental health** consequences of the climate crisis.
4. **Invisible Psychological Toll** – Mental health impacts are often "hidden," making them absent from major policy and planning frameworks.
5. **High Global Burden** – Nearly a **billion people** worldwide live with mental health disorders, which climate change threatens to worsen.
6. **Disproportionate Heat Impact** – Extreme heat hits the poor hardest, especially outdoor workers forced to choose between income and heat exposure.
7. **Psychiatric Vulnerability** – People with mental illnesses are more vulnerable to climate-related stressors, including heat and sleep disruption.
8. **PTSD and Disasters** – Flooding and other extreme weather events are predicted to significantly increase **PTSD cases** by 2050.
9. **Eco-Anxiety** – Defined by the APA as a **chronic fear** of environmental doom, it affects many, especially the youth.
10. **Youth Worry** – A 2021 Lancet survey found 60% of 16–25-year-olds highly worried about climate change; nearly half reported daily life disruption.
11. **Inequality Intensified** – The climate crisis deepens mental health issues in **marginalised communities**, increasing inequality globally.
12. **High-Risk Groups** – Those most at risk include people in fragile environments, Indigenous communities, children, women, and the economically vulnerable.
13. **Policy as a Remedy** – Climate-friendly policies, like reducing GHGs and improving infrastructure, can directly and indirectly boost mental health.
14. **Urban Solutions Help** – Green spaces, energy-efficient buildings, and better transport reduce mental strain and improve quality of life.
15. **Hope Through Action** – Like the ozone crisis, collective effort can yield positive change. Tackling climate change is also about **hope and resilience**.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



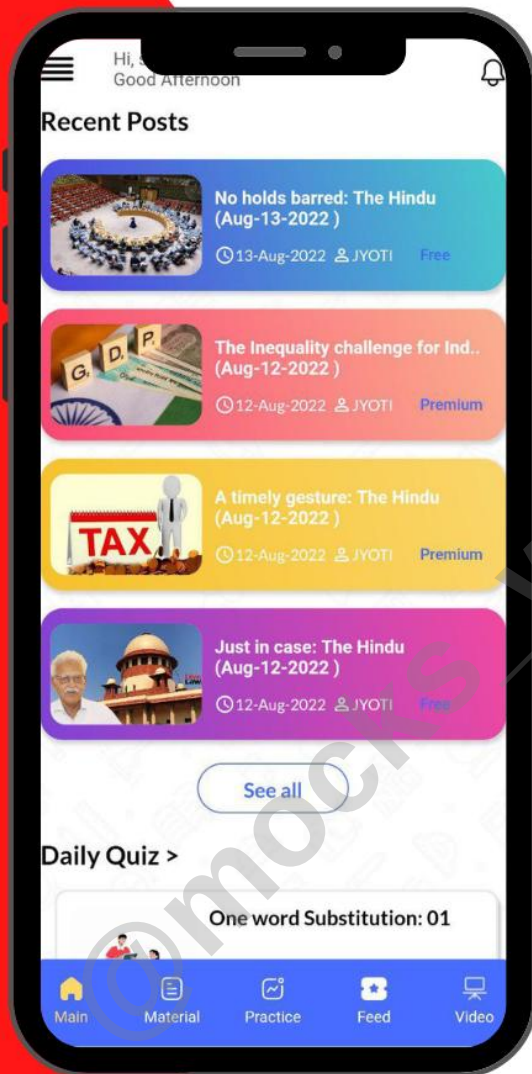
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